

Stereotaxic Depth Electrode Implantation

160.5 Links in PDF documents are not guaranteed to work. To follow a web link, please use the MCD Website.

Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

160.5

Manual Section Title

Stereotaxic Depth Electrode Implantation

Version Number

1

Effective Date of this Version

This is a longstanding national coverage determination. The effective date of this version has not been posted.

Description Information

Benefit Category

Diagnostic Tests (other)

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

The procedure employs thin wire electrodes which are implanted in the brain of the focal epileptic patient for electroencephalograph (EEG) monitoring. By taking several readings during seizure activity, the location of the epileptic focus may be found, so that better informed decisions can be made regarding the surgical treatment of persons with intractable seizures.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

Stereotaxic depth electrode implantation prior to surgical treatment of focal epilepsy for patients who are unresponsive to anticonvulsant medications has been found both safe and effective for diagnosing resectable seizure foci that may go undetected by conventional scalp EEGs.

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Stereotaxic Depth Electrode Implantation	1	01/01/1966 - N/A	You are here